Arolygiaeth Gofal Cymru
Care Inspectorate Wales

Inspection Report

Ystrad Fechan

Ystrad Fechan Bungalow, Station Road, Treorchy, CF42 6HN

01443 776007

The inspection visit took place on 23/07/2026

Service Information:

Operated by:	Rhondda Cynon Taff County Borough Council Adults and Children's Services
Care Type:	Care Home Service Adults Without Nursing
Provision for:	Care home for adults - with personal care, Provision for learning disability, Provision for mental health
Registered places:	3
Main language(s):	English
Promotion of Welsh language and culture:	The provider promotes, anticipates, identifies, and meets the Welsh language and culture needs of people.

Ratings:

Well-being	Good
Care & Support	Good
Environment	Good
Leadership & Management	Good

Summary:

Ystrad Fechan is a Local Authority respite service for adults with a learning disability and associated needs, located centrally in Treorchy. It is co-located on a site with another Local Authority service, being based in the smaller bungalow building.

Well-being is good because people are supported to make choices, maintain independence and achieve outcomes which are important to them. Strong person-centred planning, meaningful activities and positive risk-taking help people enjoy their respite experiences. Care and support is good because people receive personalised care from skilled care staff who understand their needs and preferences. Good safeguarding, medication management and infection prevention arrangements help keep people safe and well. The environment is good because people stay in a comfortable, welcoming and well-maintained setting which promotes independence and meets a wide range of needs. Leadership and management is good because leaders provide effective oversight and continue to drive improvement. Strong governance, quality assurance and learning arrangements support positive outcomes for people, while a well-trained staff team delivers consistent care.

Findings:

Well-being — Good

Well-being is good because people are supported to achieve positive outcomes through person-centred planning, meaningful choice and an environment which promotes independence and well-being. Care staff provide support centred on individual strengths, preferences and outcomes. Pre-stay assessments and reviews involve people and their families in planning support, helping people maintain control over daily routines and activities. Care staff promote positive risk-taking and support people to access activities, maintain community links and develop independence. Communication needs, cultural preferences and health needs are well understood and reflected in personal plans. Accessible information, advocacy guidance and support in Welsh are available. Effective partnership working with health professionals helps ensure health needs are met, with care staff understanding how to respond to people's support needs.

The service has good safeguarding arrangements. Care staff receive safeguarding training and understand their responsibilities. The service identifies and assesses risks before respite stays begin and work effectively with health and social care professionals to help keep people safe. Information about safeguarding, complaints, rights, and advocacy is available in accessible formats. We found safeguarding concerns are managed appropriately and in line with procedures. The service learns very well from incidents and uses this learning to improve practice, the environment and staff training, helping to strengthen outcomes for people.

People are valued as individuals and receive support which reflects their interests, strengths and preferences. Equality, diversity and inclusion are promoted through personalised support, and respite experiences focus on maintaining routines and achieving personal goals. Interests and hobbies are incorporated into support planning, and people are encouraged to remain socially active and engaged with their communities. Financial arrangements are well managed, with accurate records and effective systems in place to safeguard people's finances and property.

People stay in an environment which supports their well-being outcomes. The service offers a home-from-home experience during respite stays. Bedrooms can be personalised and the environment is flexible in responding to individual preferences, cultural needs and complex physical, behavioural and sensory requirements. Appropriate equipment and adaptations support independence and mobility, while consultation with people and professionals informs environmental improvements. The premises are well maintained, and people benefit from accessible outdoor areas and good access to community facilities.

Care & Support — Good

Care and support is good because people receive personalised care which meets their needs, promotes positive outcomes and is delivered by care staff who understand how to support them safely. People receive care and support based on person-centred plans which focus on their strengths, preferences and personal outcomes. Families are actively involved in planning support before and during respite stays, helping to ensure continuity and consistency. Transition and admission arrangements are a significant strength, being tailored to each person and introduced at a pace which suits them. Care files include detailed information from health and social care professionals, enabling care staff to meet people's needs safely and consistently. Risk assessments support positive outcomes while helping people maintain independence. Daily records provide meaningful information about people's experiences during their stay, and care staff have clear guidance about preferences, routines, activities and health needs.

People are protected through safeguarding and risk management arrangements. Leaders maintain oversight of incidents and use information to review practice and drive improvements. Safeguarding concerns are managed in line with procedures and referrals are made to local safeguarding teams when required. Risk management arrangements balance safety with people's rights, choice and well-being. The service promotes least restrictive practice and uses positive behaviour support approaches to help people achieve positive outcomes. Families and professionals are involved in decision-making where appropriate, and any restrictions are documented and understood by care staff.

People receive their medicines safely because systems are in place for the storage, administration and monitoring of medication. Medication records are accurate, and medicines are stored securely. Controlled drugs are managed appropriately. Appropriate communication with healthcare professionals supports safe medication management, and medicines are reviewed before respite stays commence. Clear communication processes ensure care staff are aware of any changes, while regular audits help identify and address issues promptly.

People benefit from a clean environment which supports their health and well-being. The service maintains thorough standards of hygiene throughout, and care staff follow detailed cleaning schedules. Effective infection prevention and control arrangements reduce the risk of infection and help keep people safe. Cleaning equipment is used appropriately, and suitable arrangements are in place for laundry and clinical waste. Care staff have access to sufficient supplies to maintain good infection control practices. Leaders understand outbreak management procedures and have suitable contingency arrangements. Regular audits provide oversight and help ensure standards remain consistently high.

Environment — Good

The environment is good because people stay in a safe, comfortable and well-maintained setting which supports their individual needs, independence and enjoyment during respite stays. The service is welcoming, homely and consistent with the Statement of Purpose. Extensive redecoration has enhanced the appearance of the service and creates a home-from-home experience for people. Accommodation is suitable for people with a wide range of mobility, physical and behavioural support needs. Specialist equipment, including profiling beds, tracking hoists and specialist seating, helps people remain comfortable and as independent as possible during their stay. Creative and personalised signage supports orientation within the service and helps people feel familiar and take ownership of their surroundings. Bedrooms are spacious and can be personalised to reflect people's preferences and needs. Rooms are equipped with items which promote comfort and well-being, including sensory resources. Communal areas are comfortable, well-presented and designed to encourage social interaction and participation in everyday activities. People have opportunities to spend time with others, take part in activities and develop daily living skills such as meal preparation.

The outdoor environment is extremely positive. People have access to outdoor facilities which promote physical activity, relaxation and enjoyment. Leaders continue to invest in the outdoor space and have plans to further enhance facilities, including the development of a summer house and a ground-level trampoline. These improvements aim to increase opportunities for recreation and meaningful engagement during respite stays. This shows a clear commitment to continuous improvement. Alongside the improvements already completed, plans are in place to further develop other outdoor areas. This ongoing investment helps ensure the environment continues to meet people's changing needs and supports positive outcomes.

People benefit from an environment which is clean, well lit, comfortable and maintained to a very good standard. Bathroom facilities are safe, accessible and meet a range of individual needs. The service is secure, with health and safety more generally well-managed. Fire safety checks, maintenance records and health and safety documentation are current and demonstrate effective oversight of the premises.

Leadership & Management — Good

Leadership and management is good because leaders maintain effective oversight of the service, support positive outcomes for people and seek to drive continuous improvement. The manager maintains oversight of quality, safety and performance. We found strong values-led leadership, with a clear focus on supporting positive outcomes for people and ongoing improvement of the service. Monitoring systems, regular audits and reflective practice help leaders identify trends, respond to issues and improve the quality of support provided. Leaders maintain oversight of incidents, safeguarding matters and service performance, and use this information to inform service development and practice improvement. We saw evidence lessons are learned from events and changes are implemented to improve outcomes for people. The Responsible Individual (RI) visits to the service, and reviews of the quality of care, provide an additional level of oversight and meet regulatory requirements. Leaders work well with external professionals and demonstrate good planning and consultation when developing the service. Although the service is operating within a challenging staffing context and organisational change, the quality of the service has generally been maintained.

People benefit from support provided by a skilled, well-trained and passionate staff team. Care staff receive comprehensive training which reflects people's individual needs, including specialist training in areas such as epilepsy and positive behaviour management. Staff registrations with Social Care Wales are maintained, supervision arrangements are appropriate and staff development is actively encouraged. The induction programme prior to new care staff starting is thorough and helps prepare for their role. Staff files contain the required regulatory information. Care staff told us, "*It's lovely, really, really lovely. The manager is really approachable. If I'm unsure, I can talk to them, and we find a solution together…absolutely brilliant*" and "*I find it really supportive here. I enjoy working with staff and individuals and find staff really supportive*." These comments reflect aspects of the positive culture within the service. We found leaders have a strong commitment to supporting and developing care staff. We are aware of staffing issues impacting on the service. We discussed these with the RI and how they can impact both respite bookings and staff well-being. We are assured the RI, who is new in post, is aware of these challenges and is taking steps to address them.

Areas identified for improvement

Where we identify **Areas for Improvement** but we have not found outcomes for people to be at immediate or significant risk, we discuss these with the provider. We expect the provider to take action and we will follow this up at the next inspection.

Where we find outcomes for people **require significant improvement** and/or there is risk to people's well-being we identify areas for **Priority Action**. In these circumstances we issue a Priority Action Notice(s) to the Provider, and they must take immediate steps to make improvements. We will inspect again within six months to check improvements have been made and outcomes for people have improved.

CIW has no areas for improvement identified following this inspection.

CIW has not issued any Priority action notices following this inspection.

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